



THE DINKA OF SOUTHERN SUDAN, like their neighbors the Nuer, are a DINKA

LIFE IN THE CATTLE CAMP

seminomadic people. Although they grow crops and keep various animals, the Dinka particularly treasure their cattle. During the short rainy season

Cattle wealth

The Dinka people are very proud of the long-horned cows that represent their wealth. Such is the importance of cattle that the Dinka write songs about their animals and perform dances to honor them. When a Dinka boy wants to marry he offers cattle to the girl's family. And when there is a dispute, cattle are given to the wronged party by a court of Dinka elders.

Dinka select cattle for the size of their horns.

A HOME FOR EACH SEASON

During the dry season the Dinka and their cattle move to camps by a river, leaving only the old and infirm in the villages. But when the rains come and the riverside grasslands become swampy they return to their villages once more. There they live in small groups of grass-roofed, mud houses and cultivate crops such as sorghum and millet.

